all over the world. The world generates about 30 million metric tonnes of CO_2 equivalent per year. There are a few chemical substances, like ozone-depleting substances, that also impact the global environment.

Numerous metals and minerals are used as raw materials in the production of industrial goods and machines. Many minerals when used as inputs lead to production of chemicals. These chemicals are used in different ways in the production and distribution chain. Fertilizers and insecticides are chemicals that are extensively used in the production of food and other agriculture produce. Several chemicals are used to produce consumer products for use in industry, construction and households. Paints, adhesives and plastics are all products of minerals and metals. Some heavy metals, materials like plastics and noxious gases like nitrogen oxide can impact air, water and soil to create bad local environmental impacts. Some fuels and chemicals can be poisonous or otherwise bad for the health of individuals.

Most adverse environmental impacts, whether global, local or personal, can be traced to the use of fossil fuels, chemicals and heavy metals.

The environment gets adversely impacted in carrying out processes that are incidental or essential to production of fossil fuels and materials and processes deployed to allow the release/disposal of by-products of the products manufactured.

Fossil fuels, metal and minerals are extracted from the womb of the earth. The process of extraction involves disturbing tree and soil cover and disturbs the carbon balance in nature and nutritional balance of soil. It also releases soil and other substances in water and air. The dumps of overburden in coal and other mining areas are stark reminders of the local pollution caused by the processes of excavation and extraction.

The disposal of plastics and other solid wastes, products made of materials and chemicals, chokes local sewage disposal systems, sullies lakes and rivers and finally pollutes the seas.